

India's Employment and Economy

Growth, jobs, incomes and the digital economy, cross-read against poverty trends.

4 CHAPTERS	26 INDICATORS	7 WITH STATE DATA	1951–2026 PERIOD COVERED
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Generated 21 Aug 2026 · assembled from 25 sources

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report assembles 26 indicators across 4 chapters, drawn from 25 sources and covering 1951–2026.

Of those indicators, 7 carry state-level detail and can be mapped across India's states. The remaining 19 are published at national level only by their source, and are shown here as national series without a sub-national breakdown.

Coverage limits. This report contains no district- or city-level figures. Comparable district data is not currently integrated into India Insight Lab, and no value here has been estimated, interpolated or carried down from a higher geography to fill that gap. Where a number is absent, it is absent.

KEY FINDINGS

Each finding below is computed directly from the state values in this report — the highest and lowest recorded state for that indicator. None are authored interpretations.

1 **State-wise merchandise exports**

Ranges from 90\$bn in Maharashtra to 22\$bn in Uttar Pradesh — a spread of 68\$bn across the 6 states reported.

Trade Intelligence and Analytics portal, Department of Commerce

2 **Multidimensional poverty by state**

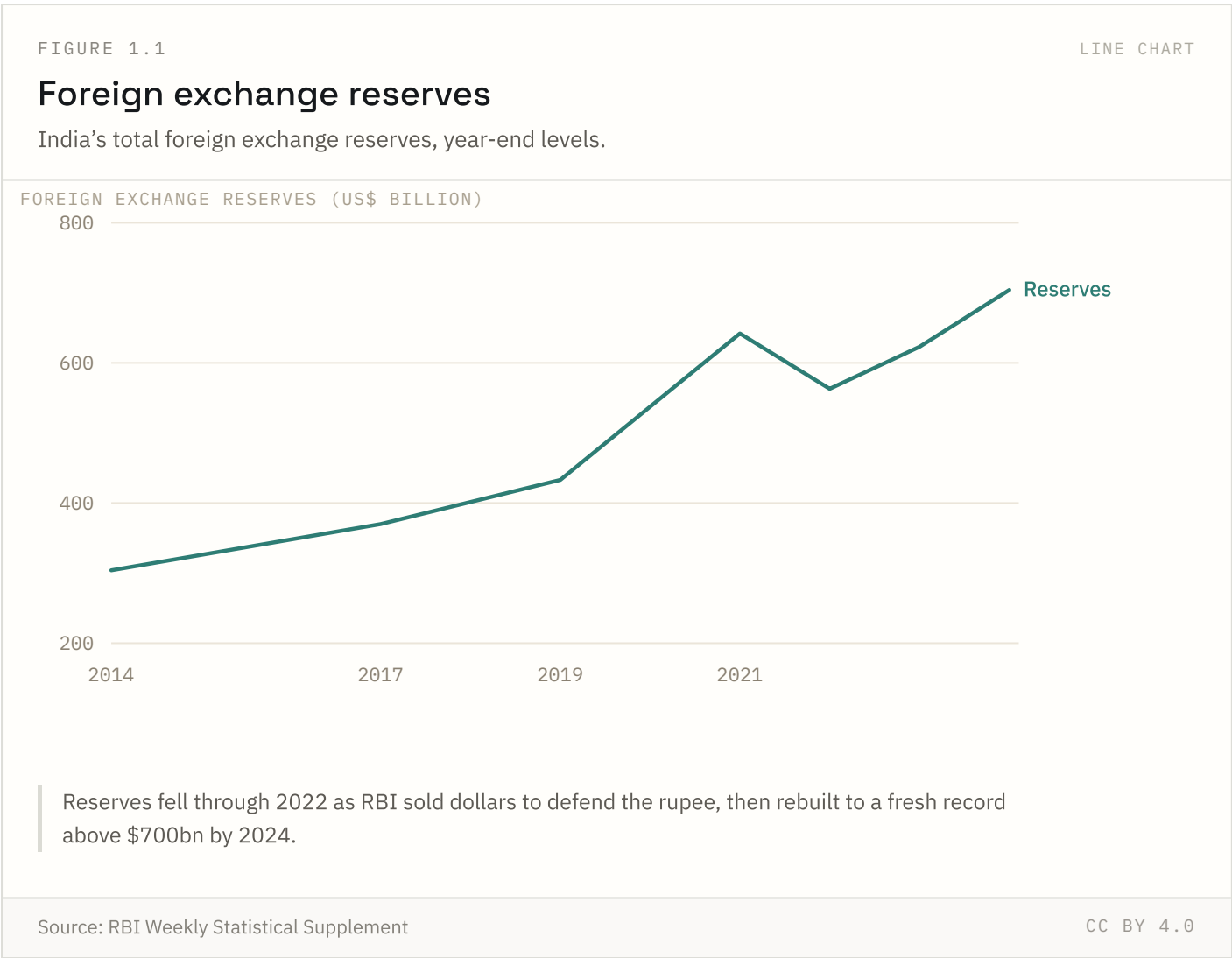
Ranges from 33.76% in Bihar to 0.55% in Kerala — a spread of 33.21% across the 25 states reported.

NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023

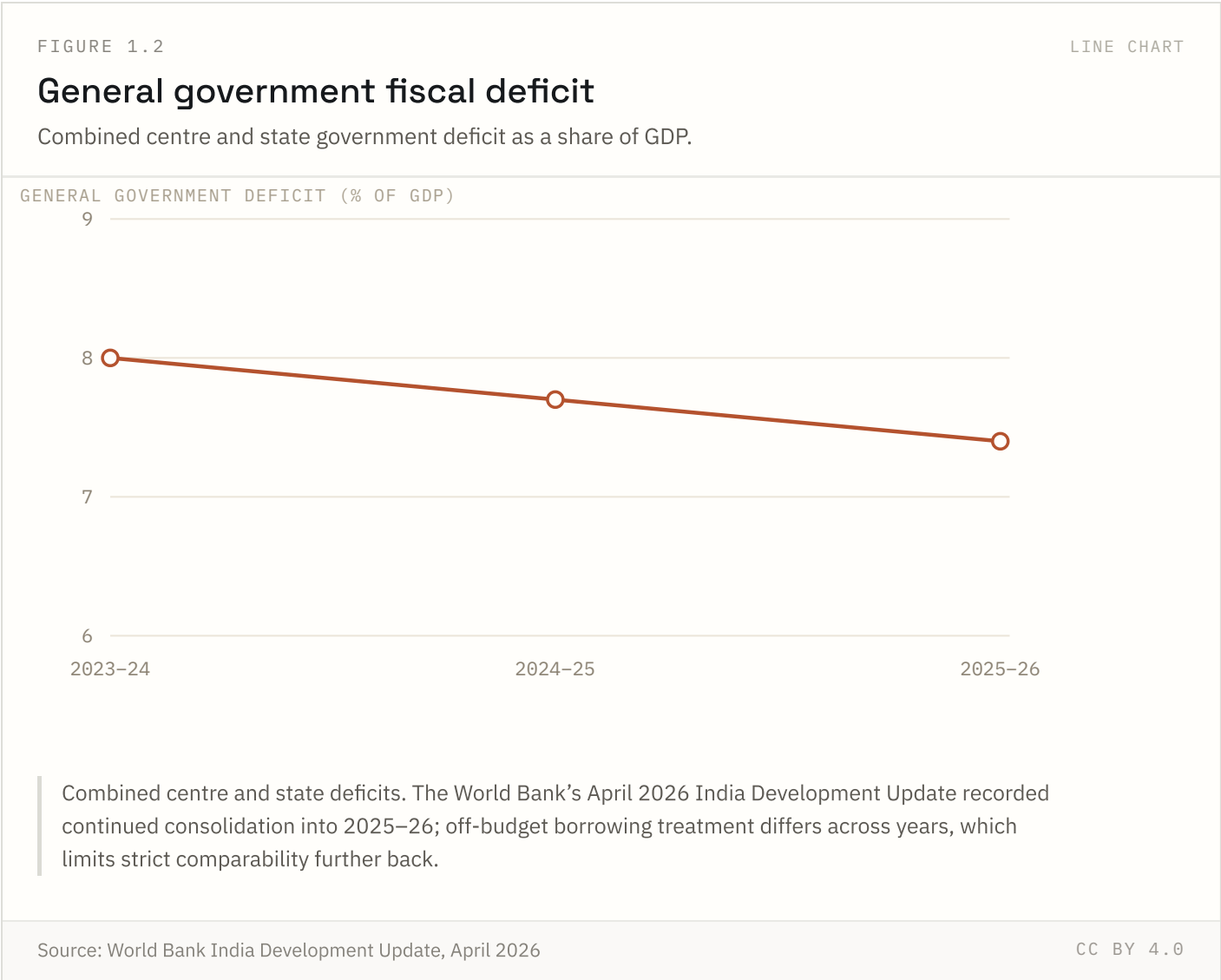
Economy & finance

1 of 13 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 1.1 NATIONAL ONLY

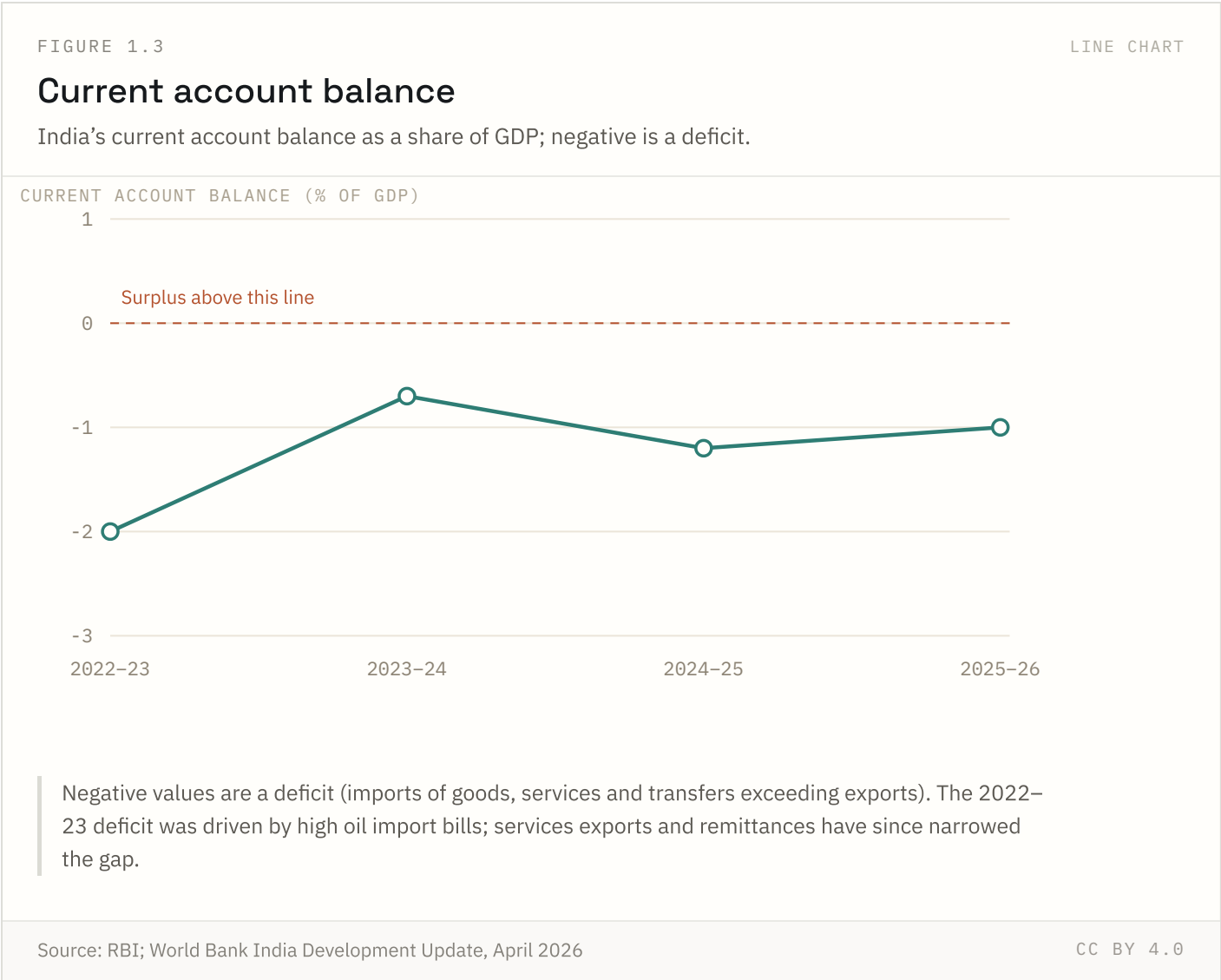


Reserves fell through 2022 as the RBI sold dollars to slow the rupee’s depreciation, then rebuilt past \$700 billion by 2024 — among the largest reserve stockpiles of any country.



The deficit has narrowed for three straight years as the centre held to its fiscal consolidation path and states’ combined deficit stayed stable. Off-budget borrowing is treated inconsistently across years and agencies, which can shift the level without a real change in underlying fiscal stance.

FIGURE 1.3 NATIONAL ONLY

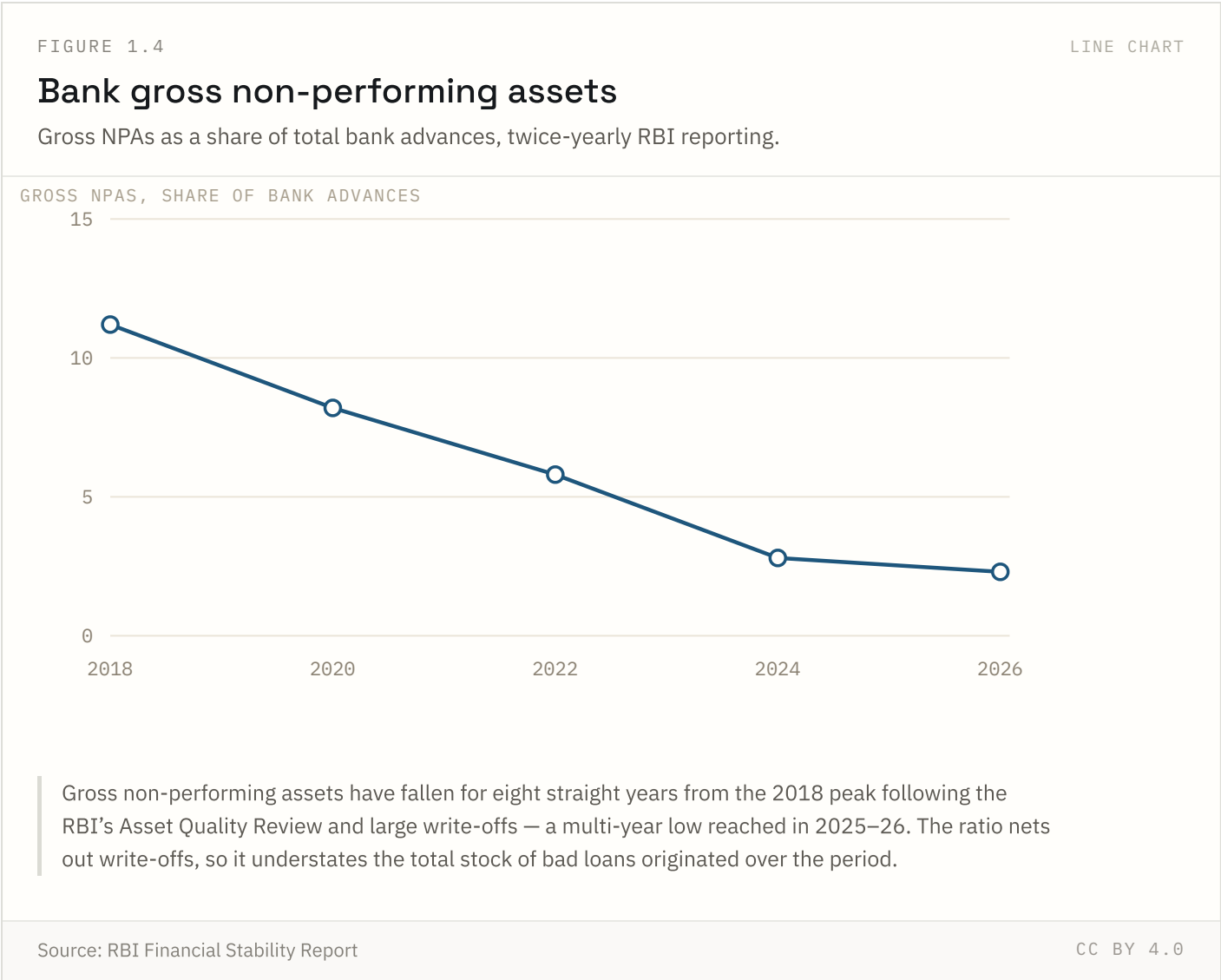


The 2022–23 deficit peaked on a high oil import bill; strong services exports and remittance inflows have since kept the deficit comfortably financeable. A current account deficit is normal for a fast-growing economy importing capital goods and energy.

Source: RBI; World Bank India Development Update, April 2026 Coverage: 2022–23 to 2025–26

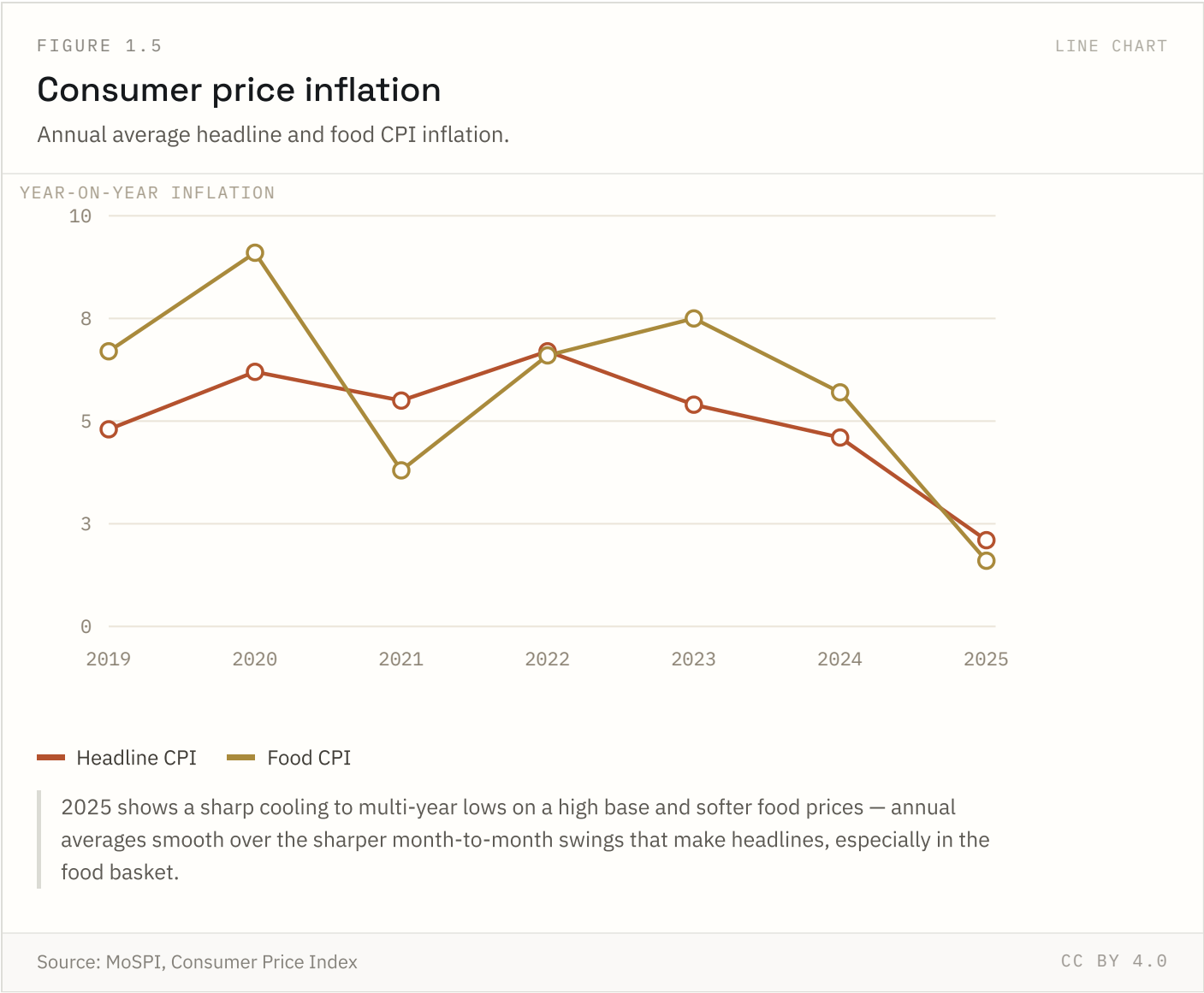
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.4 NATIONAL ONLY



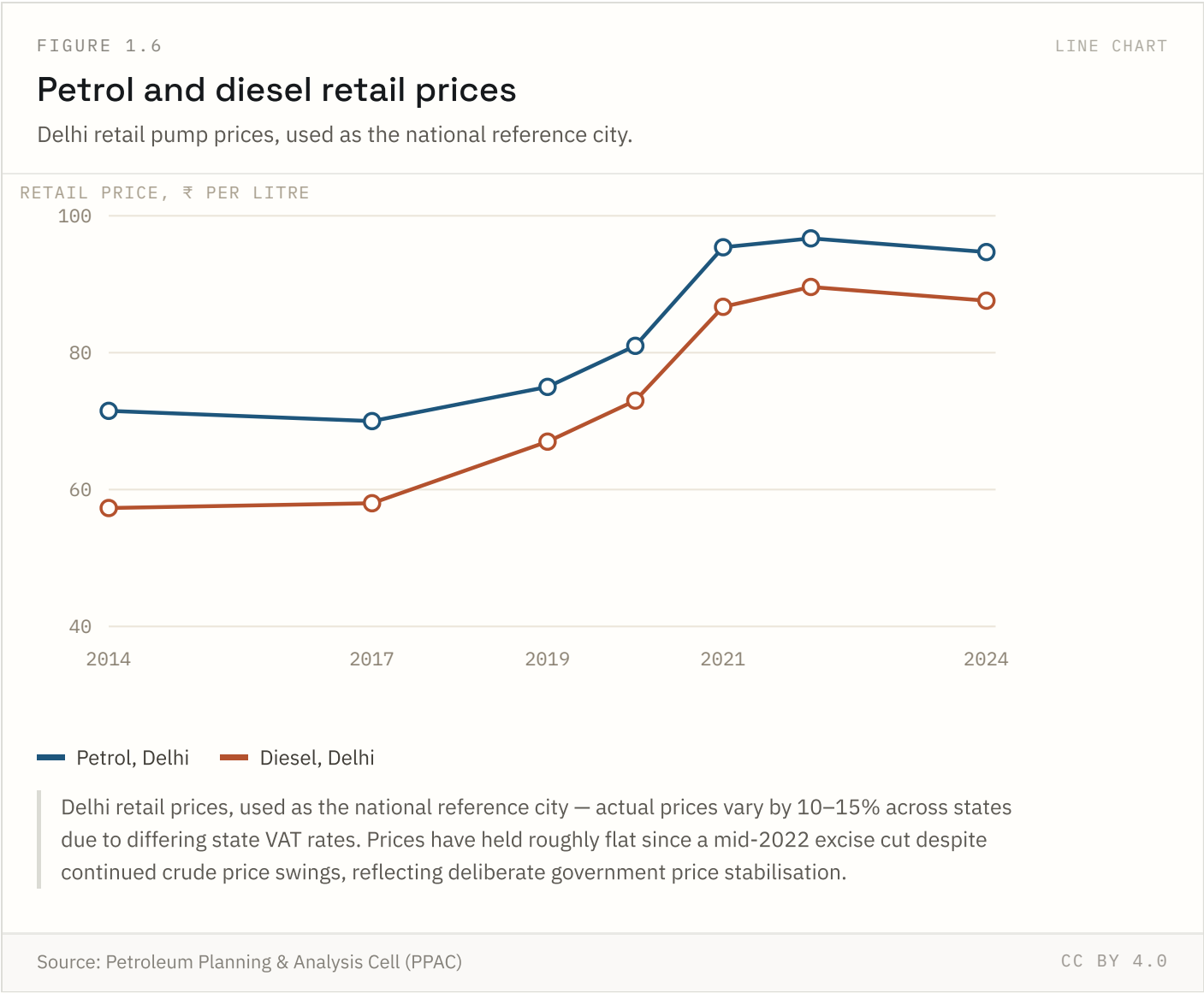
The ratio has fallen every year since the 2018 peak that followed the RBI’s Asset Quality Review, helped by large write-offs and improved recovery under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code. A falling ratio reflects both fewer new bad loans and banks removing old ones from the book, so it is not a pure flow measure.

FIGURE 1.5 NATIONAL ONLY



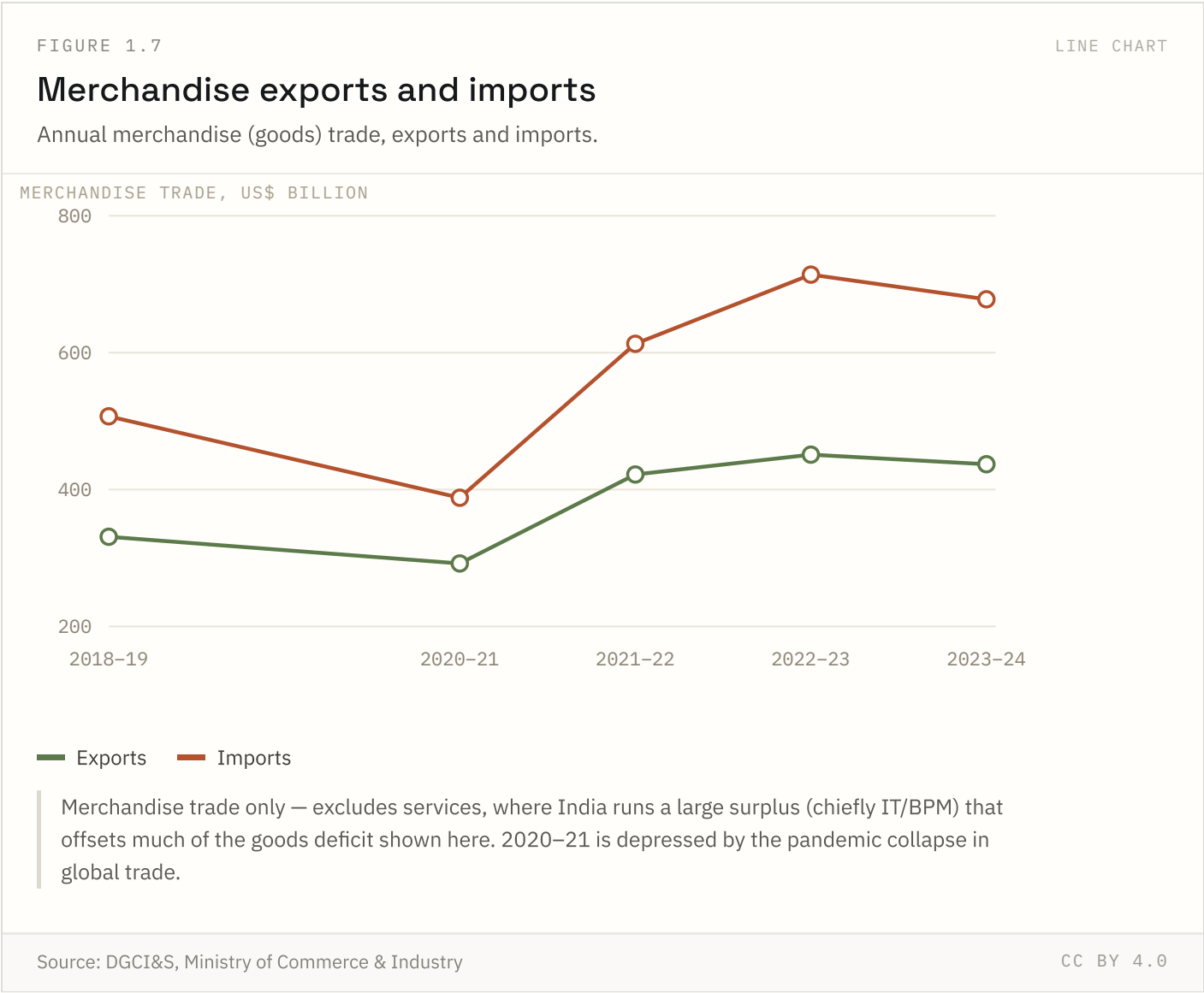
Food inflation runs more volatile than the headline rate in both directions, since it is exposed to monsoon shocks and global commodity swings that core inflation is not. Annual averages mask sharper month-to-month spikes, particularly around vegetable price shocks.

FIGURE 1.6 NATIONAL ONLY

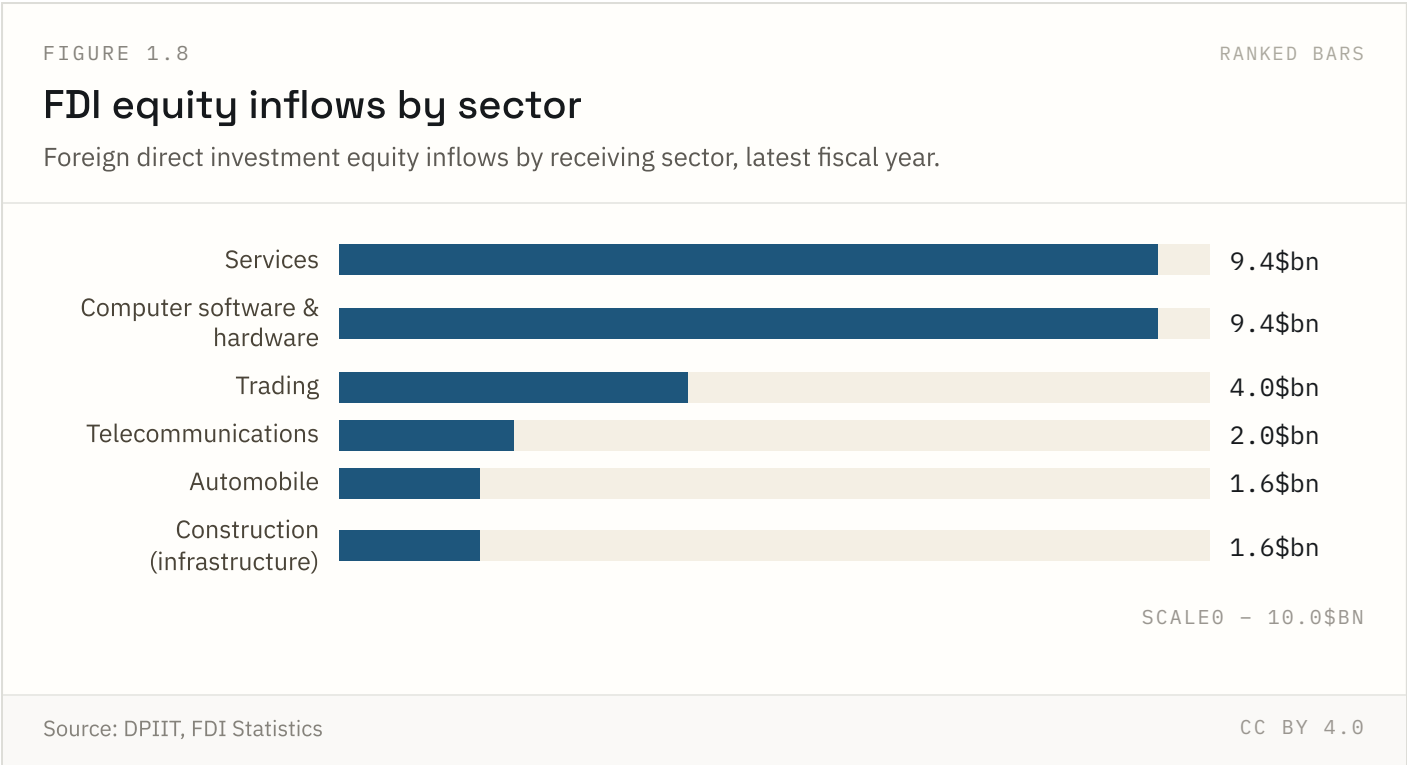


Retail prices are a mix of global crude prices, the rupee exchange rate, and state and central taxes — taxes make up roughly 40% of the pump price. Prices have barely moved since mid-2022 despite crude volatility, a deliberate stabilisation choice rather than a market outcome.

FIGURE 1.7 NATIONAL ONLY

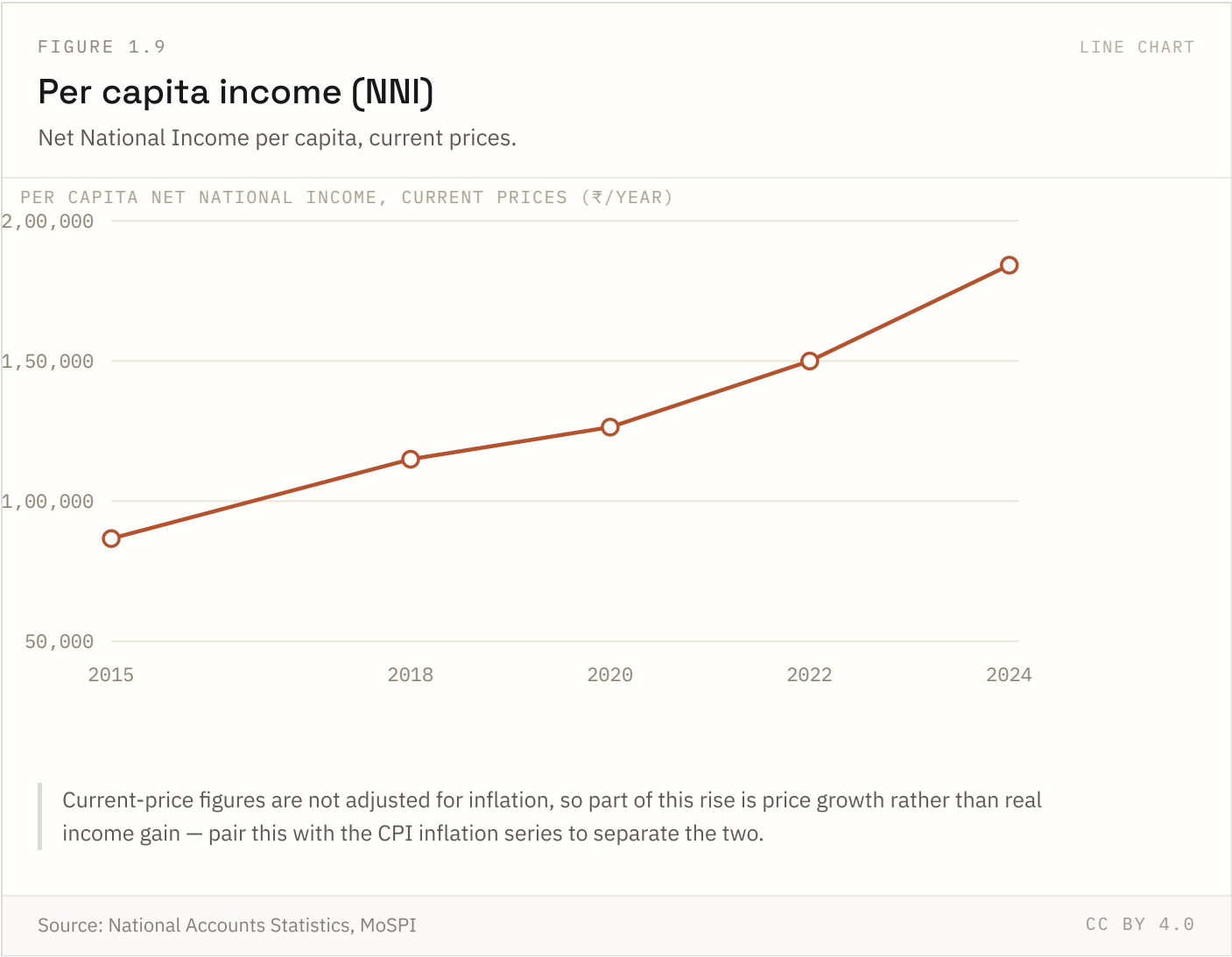


India runs a persistent merchandise trade deficit, financed in large part by a services trade surplus (led by IT/BPM exports) not shown here. The 2022-23 and 2023-24 import bills were pushed up by elevated global energy prices.

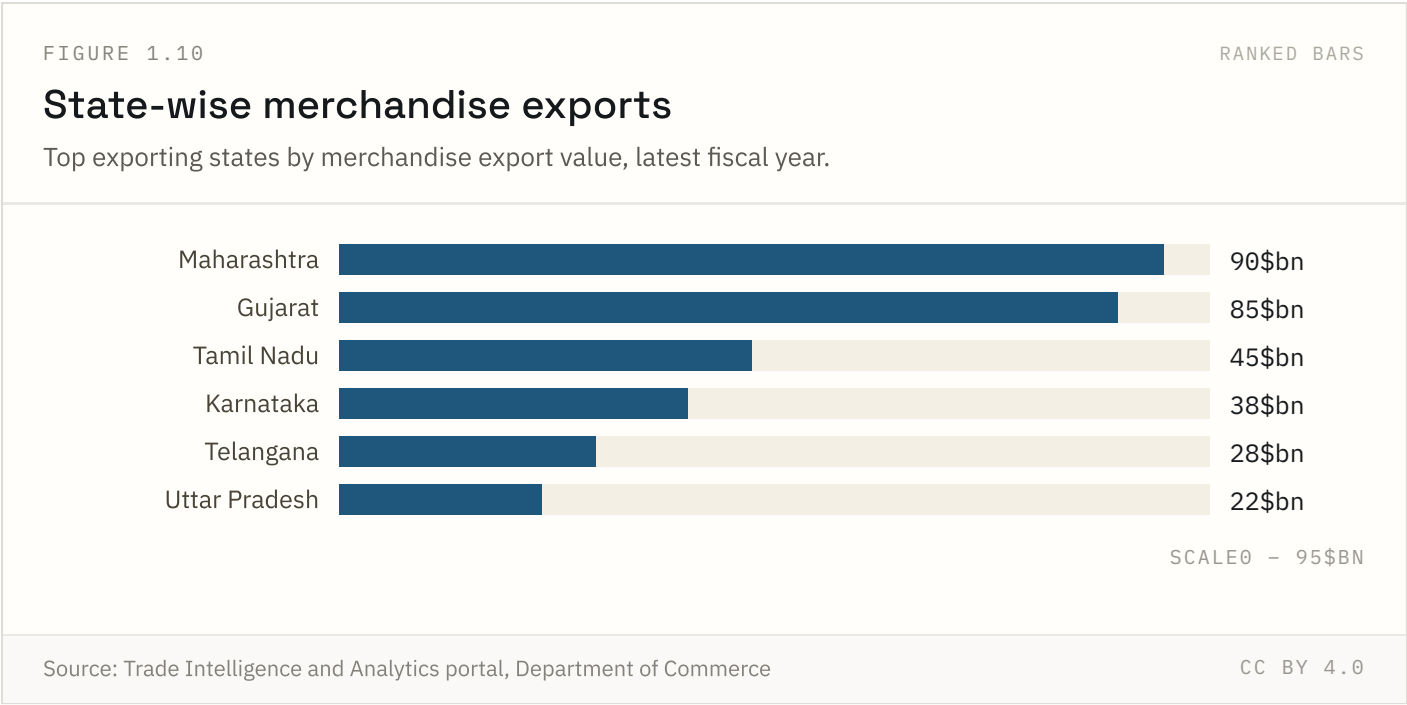


Services and computer software/hardware together draw in roughly as much FDI as the next four sectors combined, reflecting India’s pull for global capability centres and SaaS investment over manufacturing FDI. Reinvested earnings and other capital, tracked separately by DPIIT, are excluded.

FIGURE 1.9 NATIONAL ONLY

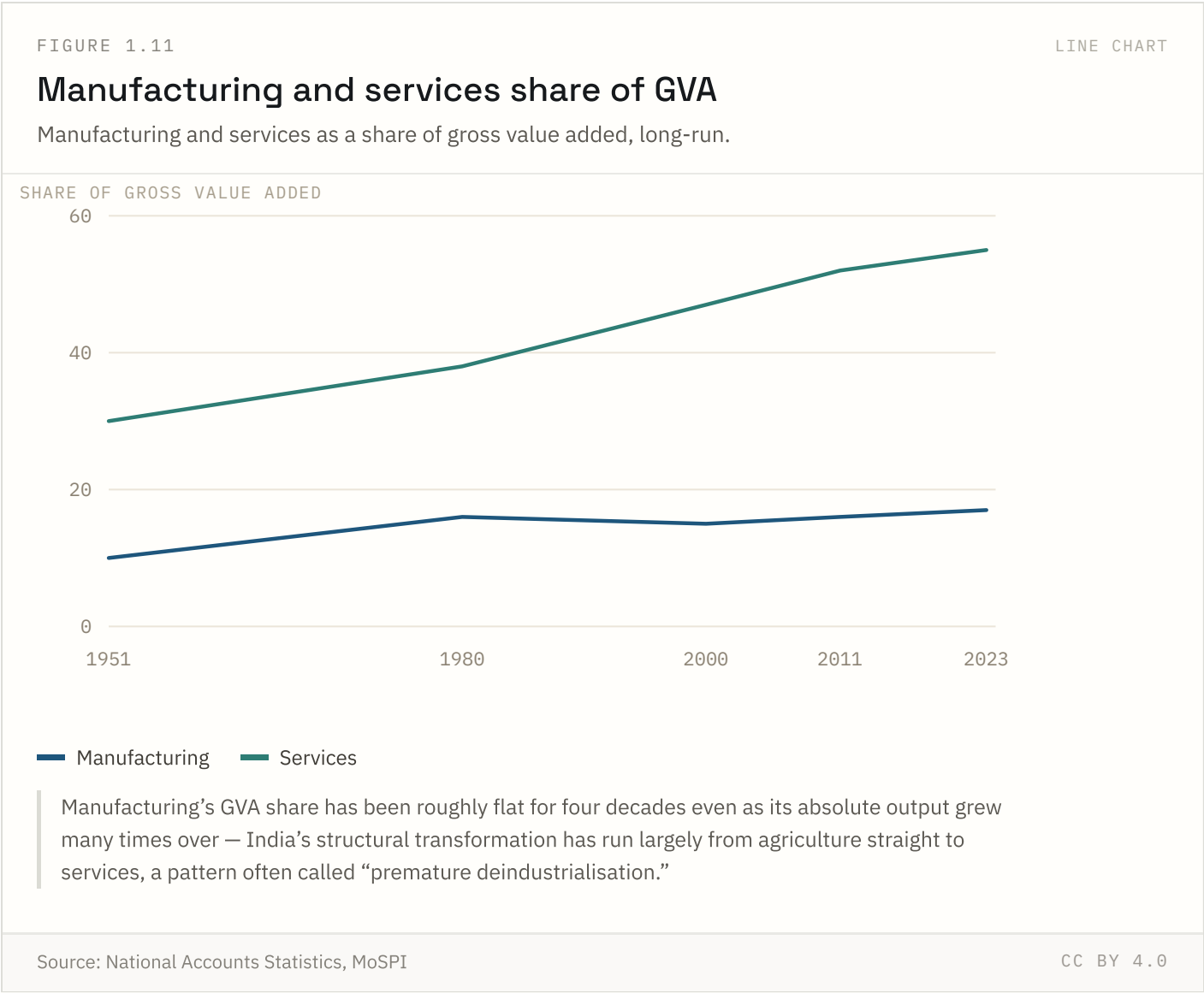


This translates aggregate GDP growth into a per-person figure, though as a national average it says nothing about distribution — pair it with the MPCE and Gini series in Poverty & incomes to see how income and consumption are actually shared.

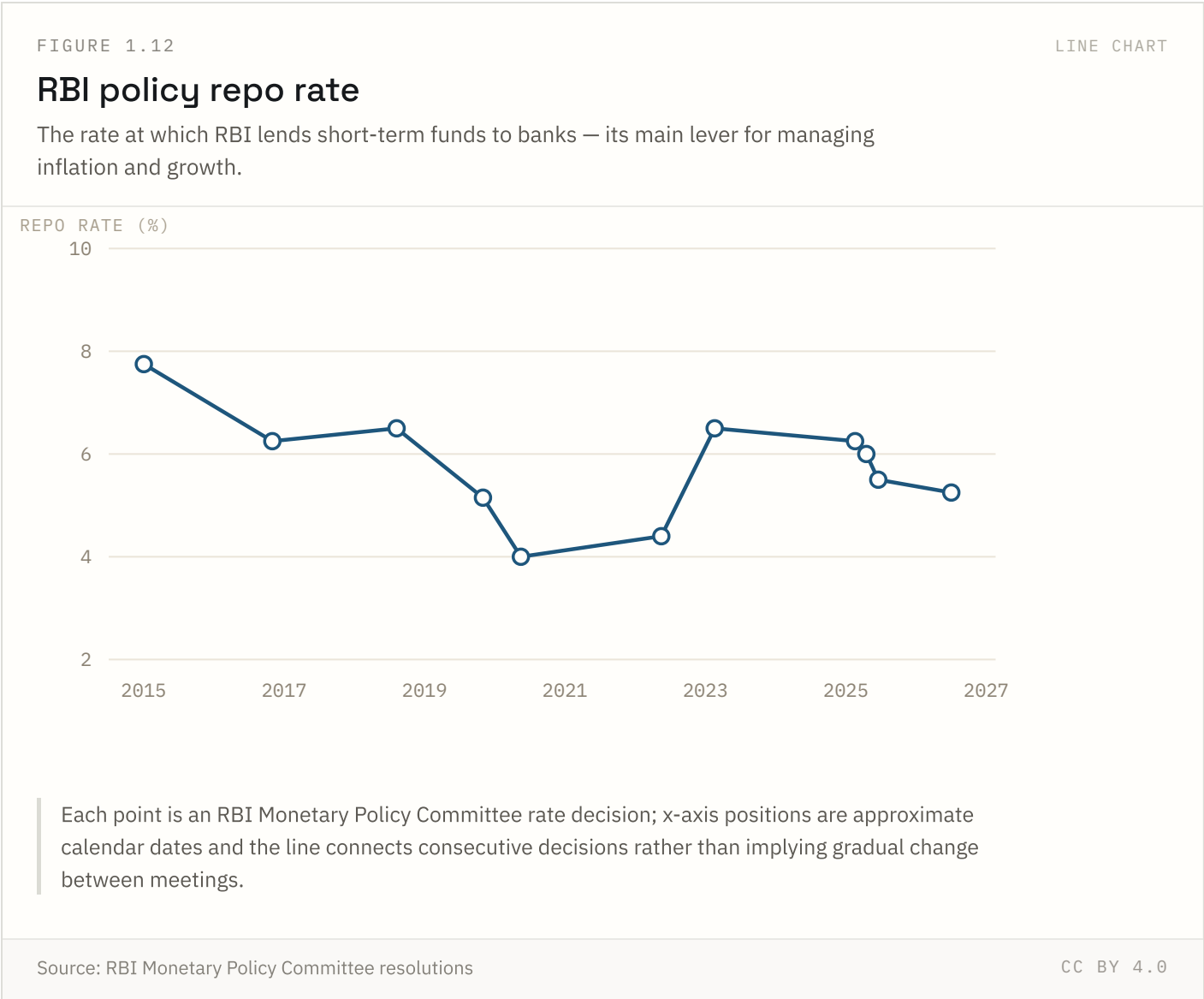


Maharashtra and Gujarat together export more than the next four states combined, reflecting concentrated port access and established manufacturing and chemicals clusters — export capacity remains far more geographically concentrated than population or GDP.

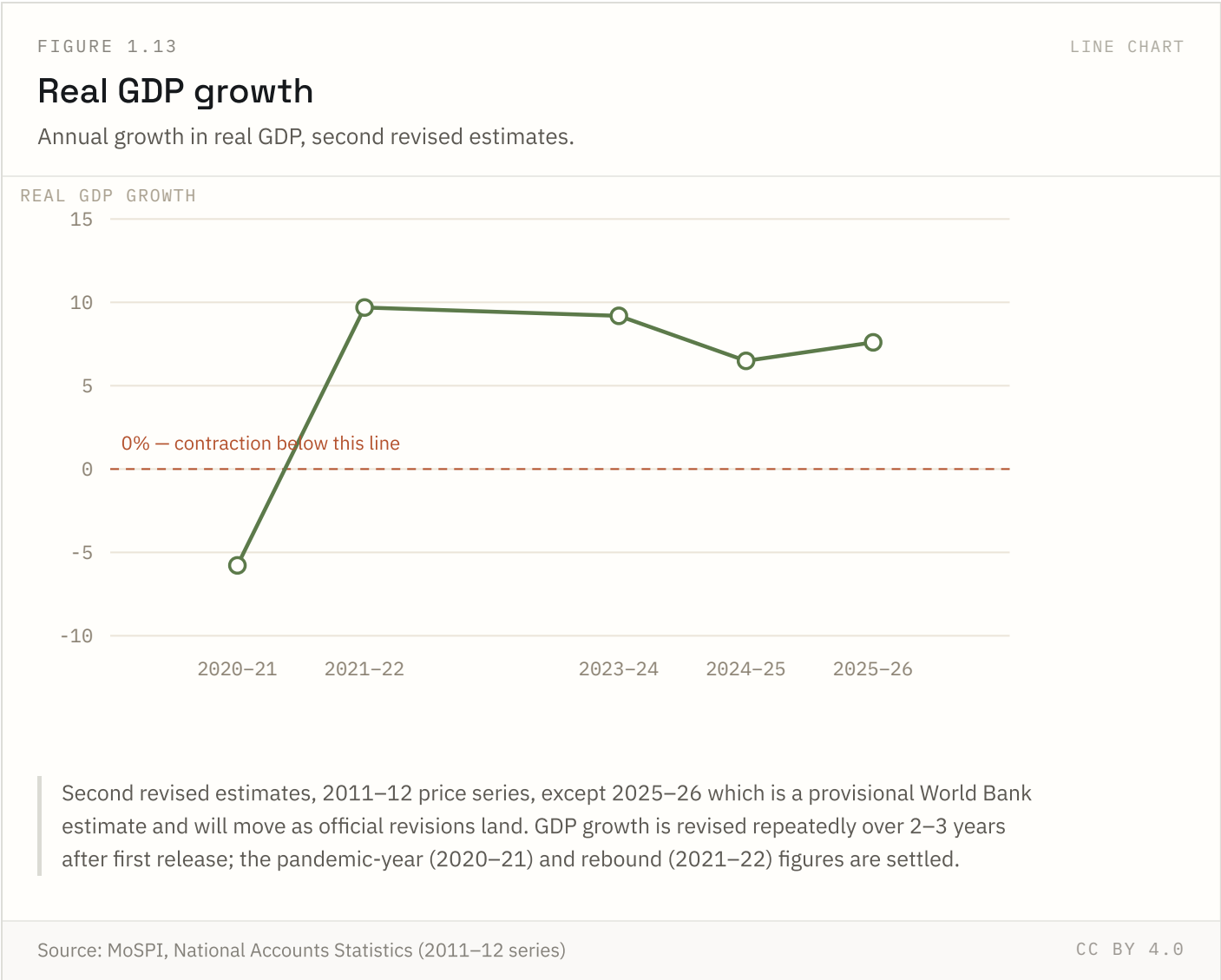
Highest: **Maharashtra** at 90\$bn. Lowest: **Uttar Pradesh** at 22\$bn.



Pairs with the Agriculture & food topic’s GVA-share chart to complete the picture: India’s economy moved from agriculture-dominated to services-dominated with manufacturing’s share barely moving — a structural pattern quite different from China’s manufacturing-led transition.



Each point is an actual policy decision, not a smoothed average. The rate fell to a historic low of 4.00% during the pandemic, then rose 250 basis points across 2022–23 to fight inflation, and has eased since early 2025 as inflation moderated.



GDP estimates are revised repeatedly over two to three years after first release. The 2020–21 contraction and 2021–22 rebound are now settled figures; 2023–24 and 2024–25 may still move in future revisions.

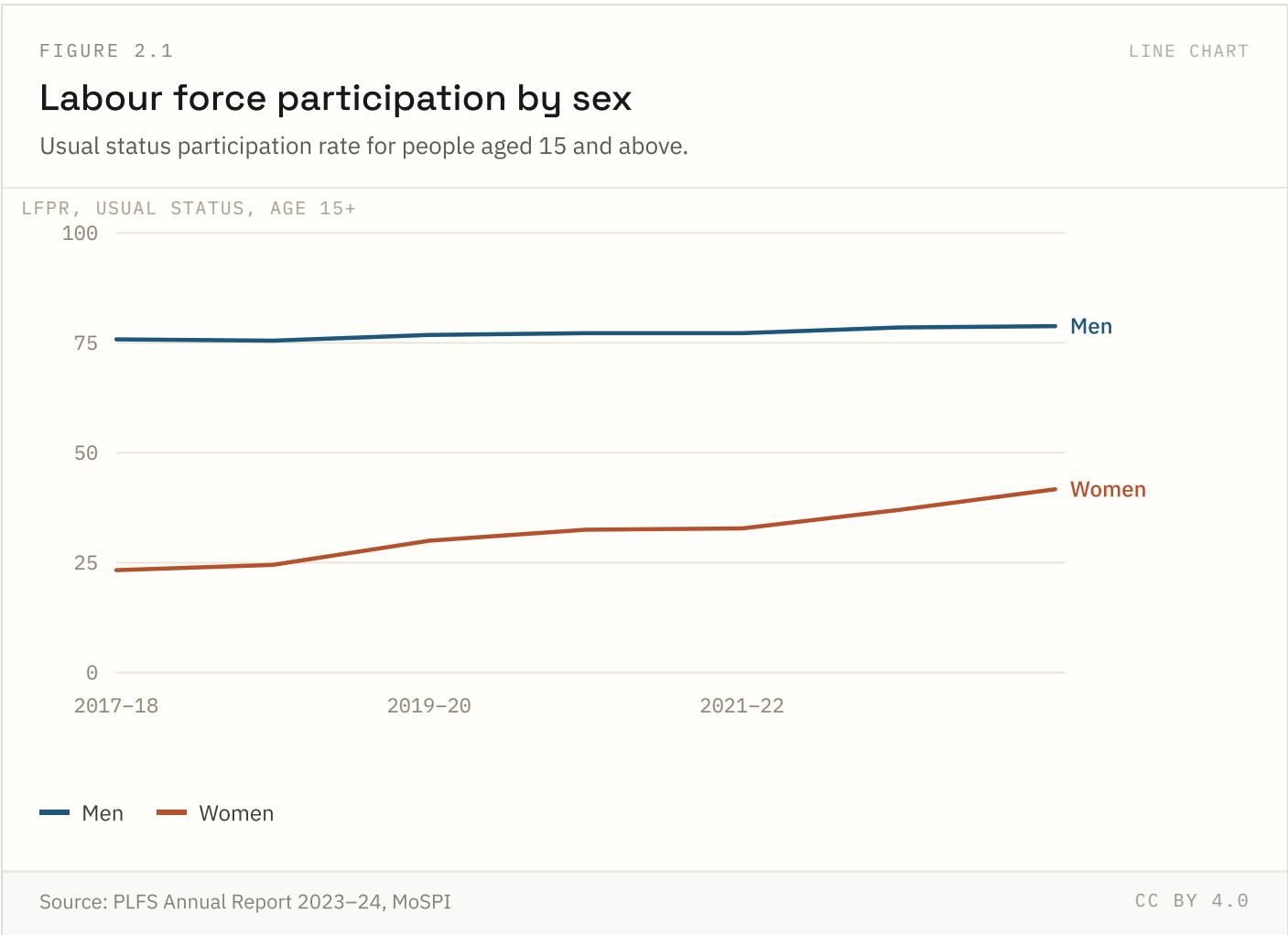
Source: MoSPI, National Accounts Statistics (2011–12 series) Coverage: 2020–21 to 2024–25

Updated: 16 Aug 2026

Employment & labour

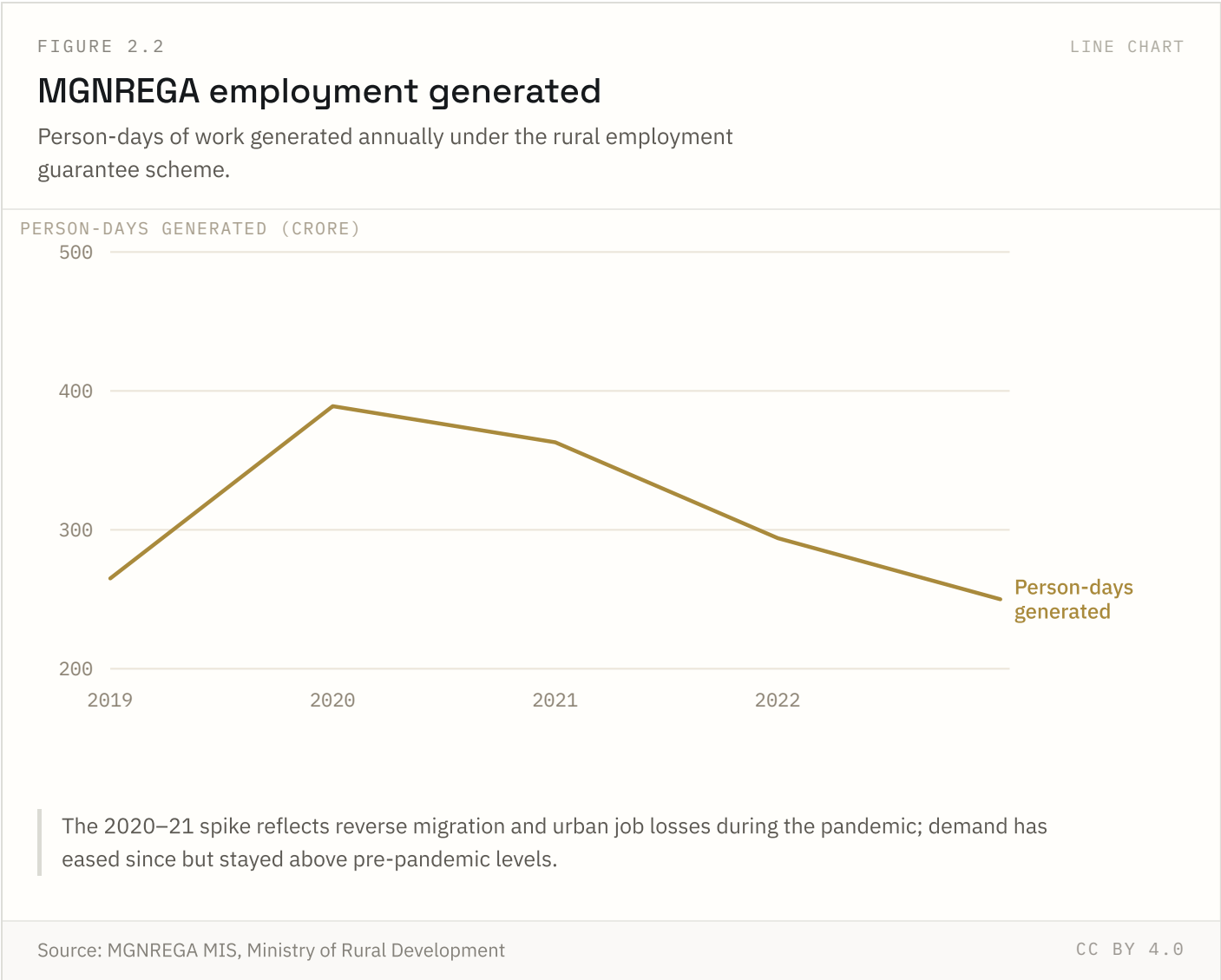
2 of 3 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 2.1 NATIONAL + STATE



Female participation has risen sharply since 2018 on the PLFS usual-status definition, but most of the increase is in unpaid work on family farms and enterprises. Salaried employment for women has grown far more slowly.

FIGURE 2.2 NATIONAL ONLY



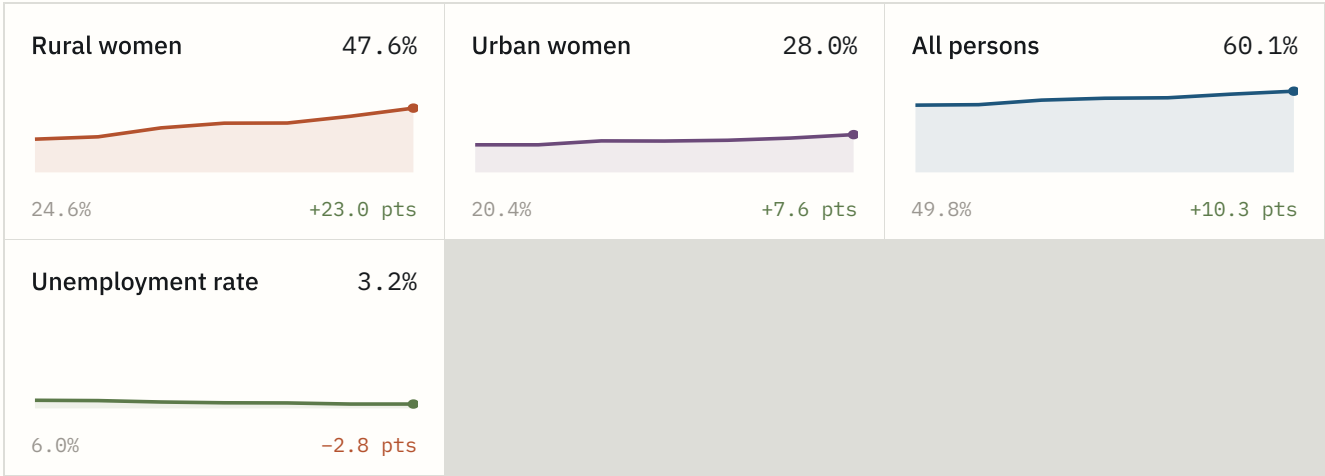
The scheme acts as an automatic stabiliser: person-days jumped 47% in 2020–21 as migrant workers returned to villages during the pandemic, then eased as urban labour markets recovered.

FIGURE 2.3

SMALL MULTIPLES

Labour force participation — small multiples

Four series on one shared 0–65% scale, so the panels can be compared directly.



2017-18 → 2023-24, EACH PANEL ON THE SAME 0-65 % SCALE

Same scale in every panel, so the panels are directly comparable. Rural women drive almost the whole national increase.

Source: PLFS Annual Reports 2017-18 to 2023-24, MoSPI

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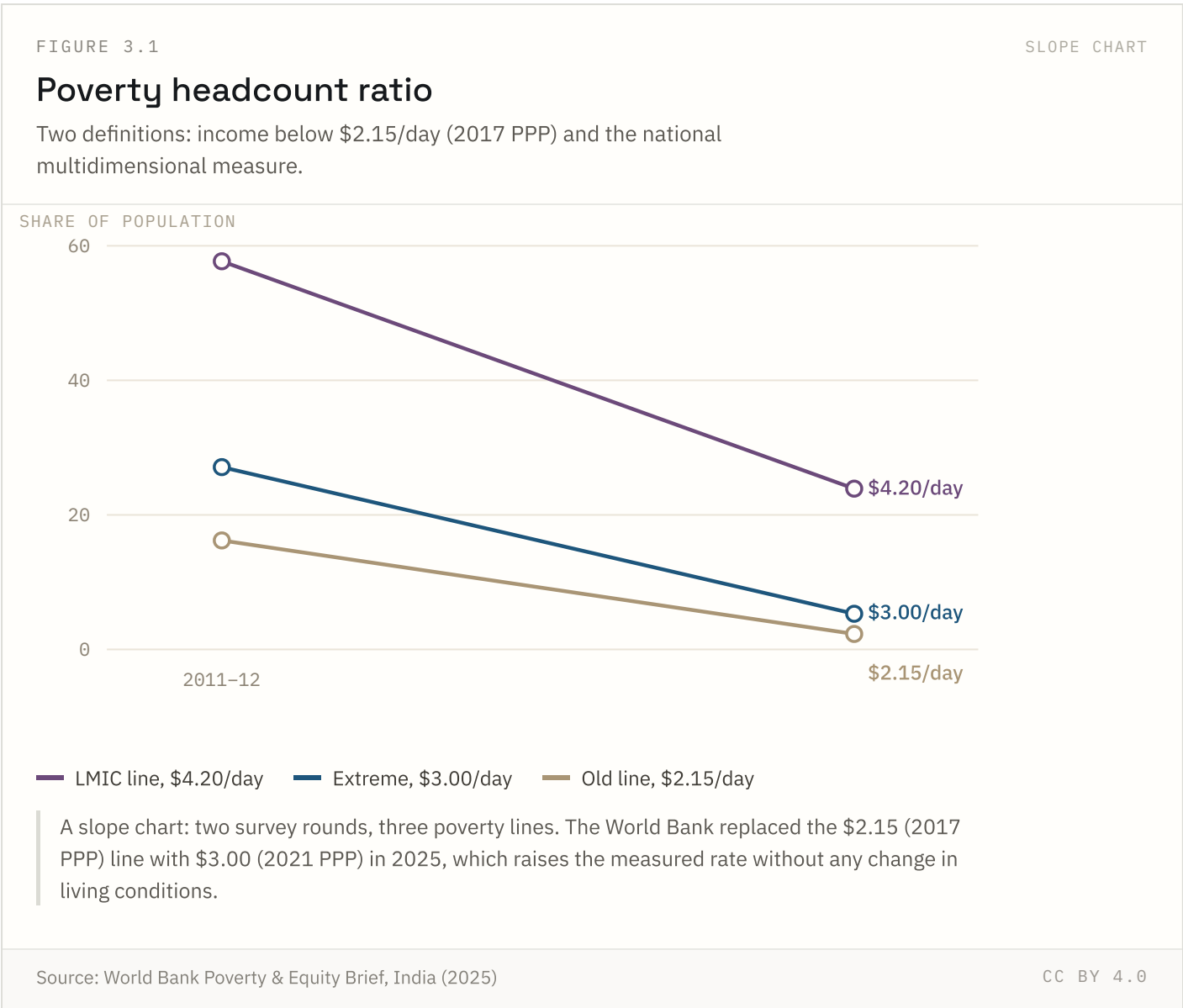
Rural women account for almost the entire national increase: their LFPR nearly doubled from 24.6% to 47.6%, while urban women moved from 20.4% to 28.0%. Part of the change is measurement — PLFS probes unpaid work in family enterprises more carefully than the surveys it replaced.

Source: PLFS Annual Reports 2017-18 to 2023-24, MoSPI Coverage: 2017-18 to 2023-24 Updated: 21 Jul 2026

Poverty & incomes

3 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 3.1 NATIONAL + STATE



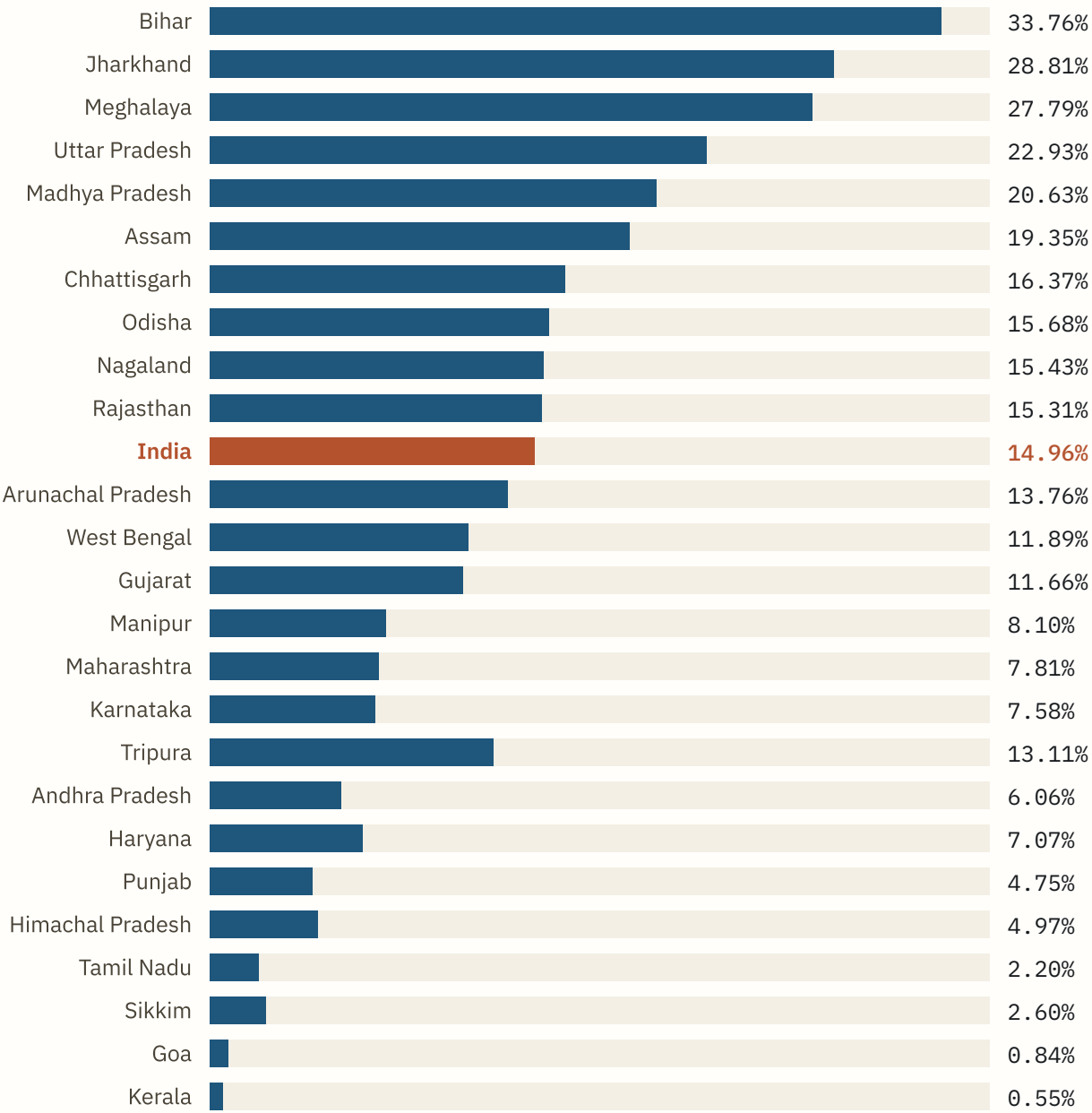
Income poverty and multidimensional poverty answer different questions. The MPI counts deprivations in nutrition, schooling, sanitation, fuel, housing and assets; a household can escape the income line while remaining multidimensionally poor, and often does.

FIGURE 3.2

RANKED BARS

Multidimensional poverty by state

Share of the population identified as multidimensionally poor, NFHS-5 round.



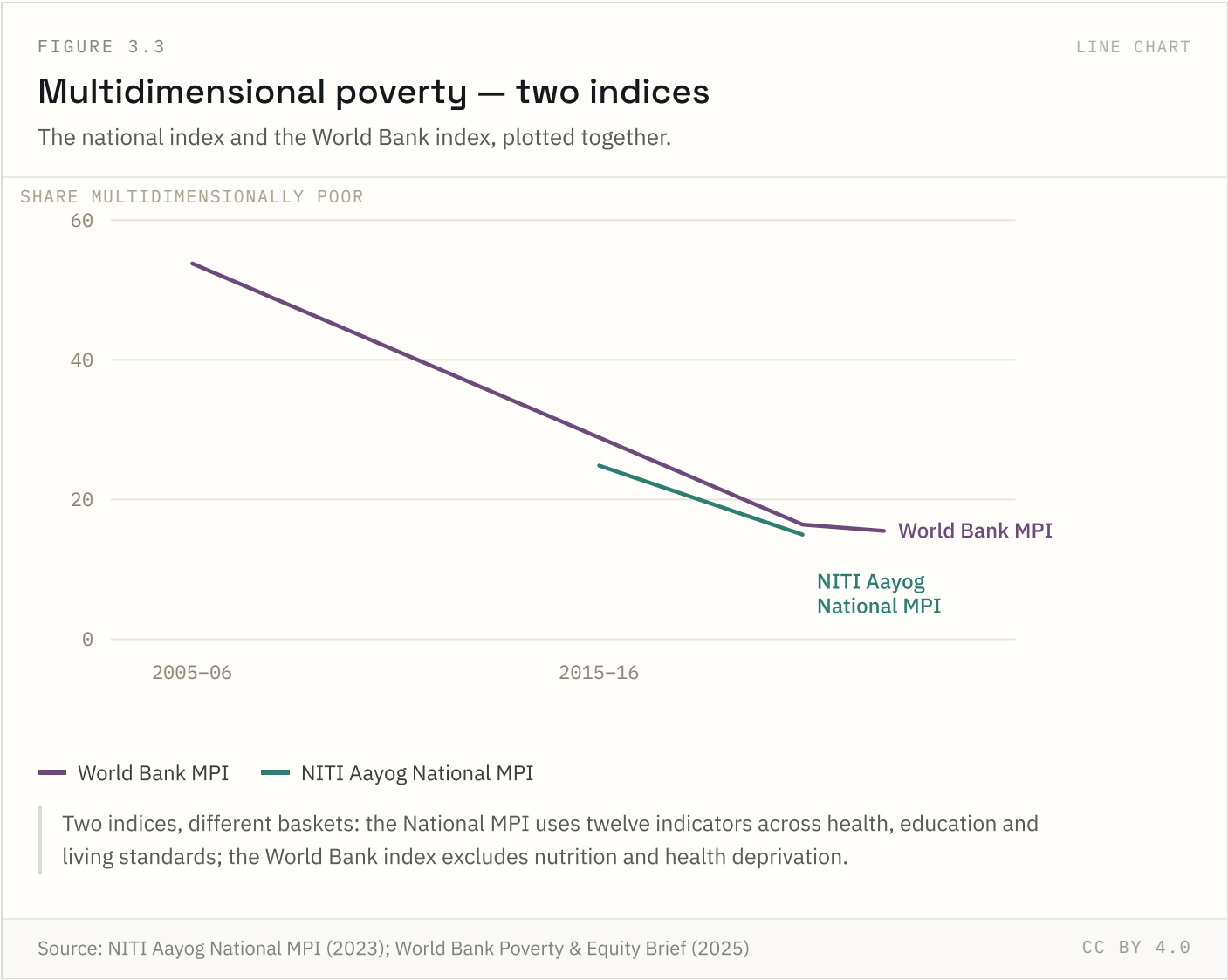
SCALE 0 - 36.00%

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI – A Progress Review 2023

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The National MPI uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards. Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh together account for roughly half of India’s multidimensionally poor population.

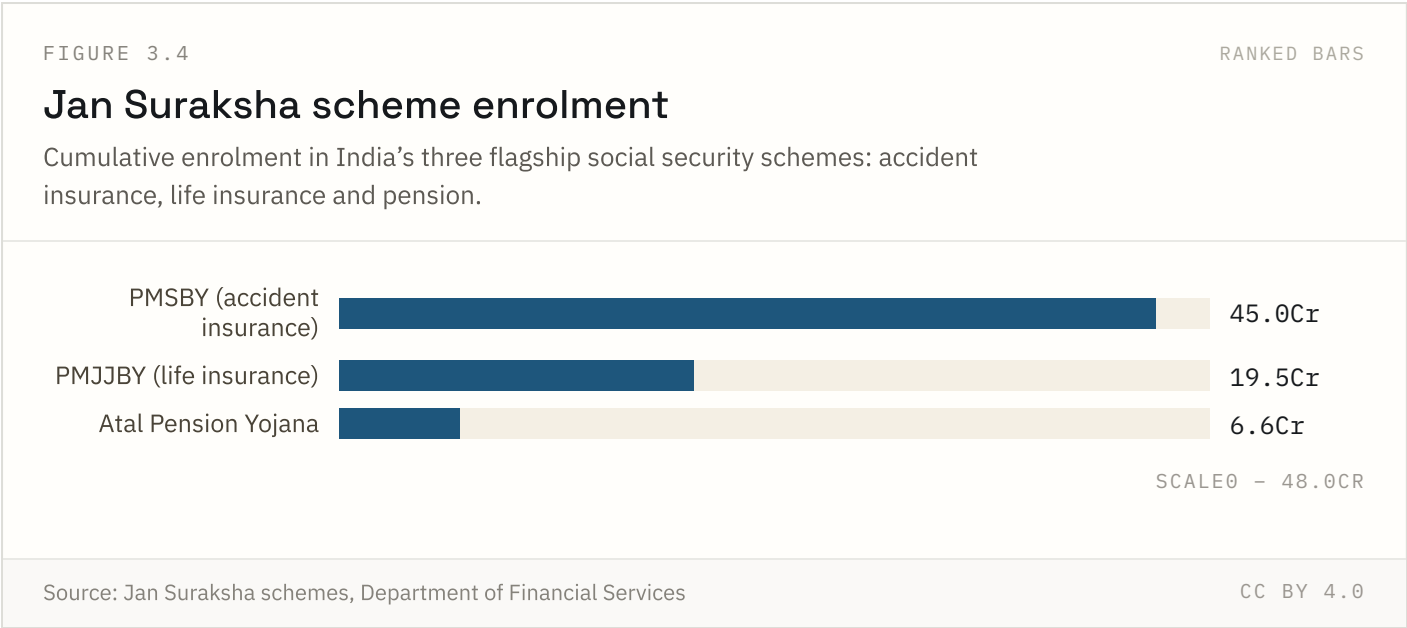
Highest: **Bihar** at 33.76%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 0.55%.



The two indices use different baskets — the National MPI counts twelve indicators including nutrition and maternal health, the World Bank version excludes them — so they should be read as bounds rather than as competing estimates of one quantity.

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025) Coverage: 2005-06 to 2022-23

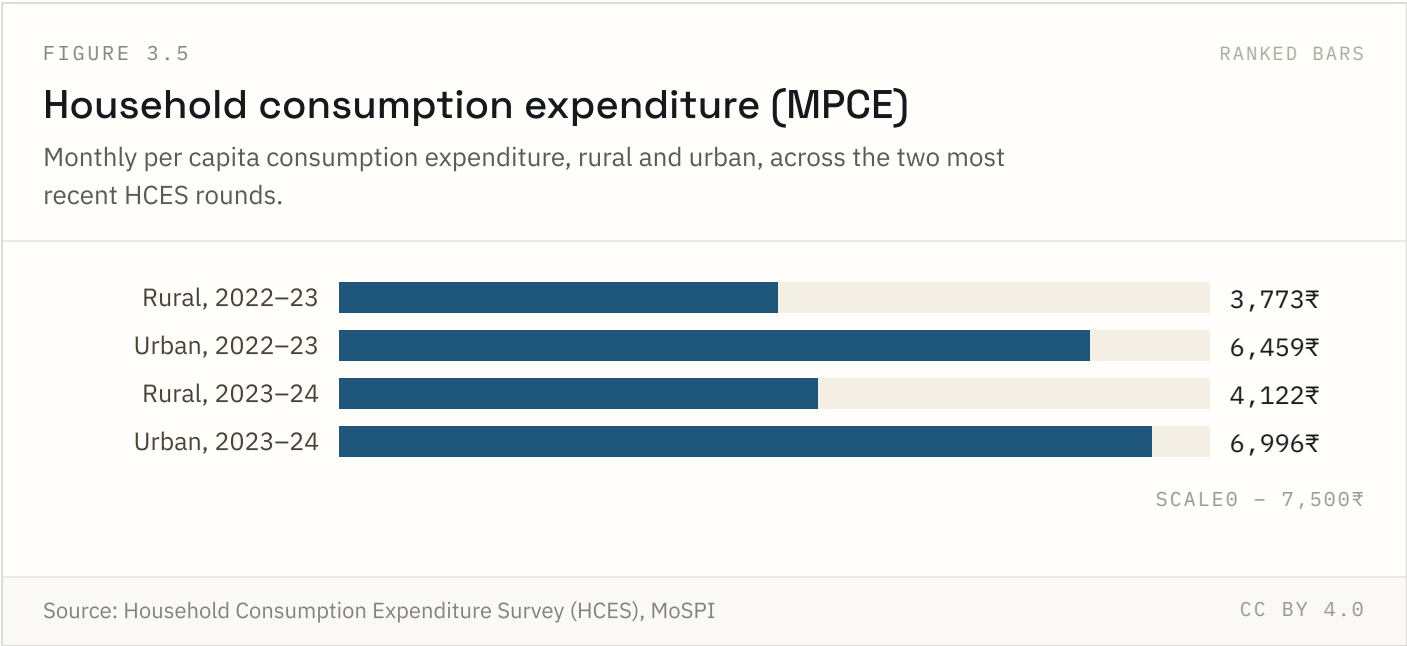
Updated: 24 Jul 2026



PMSBY’s low annual premium (₹20) drives far higher enrolment than the pension scheme, which requires a recurring contribution. Enrolment counts include lapsed and inactive accounts in most published figures, so active coverage is somewhat lower than these cumulative totals suggest.

Source: Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services Coverage: Cumulative to 2024

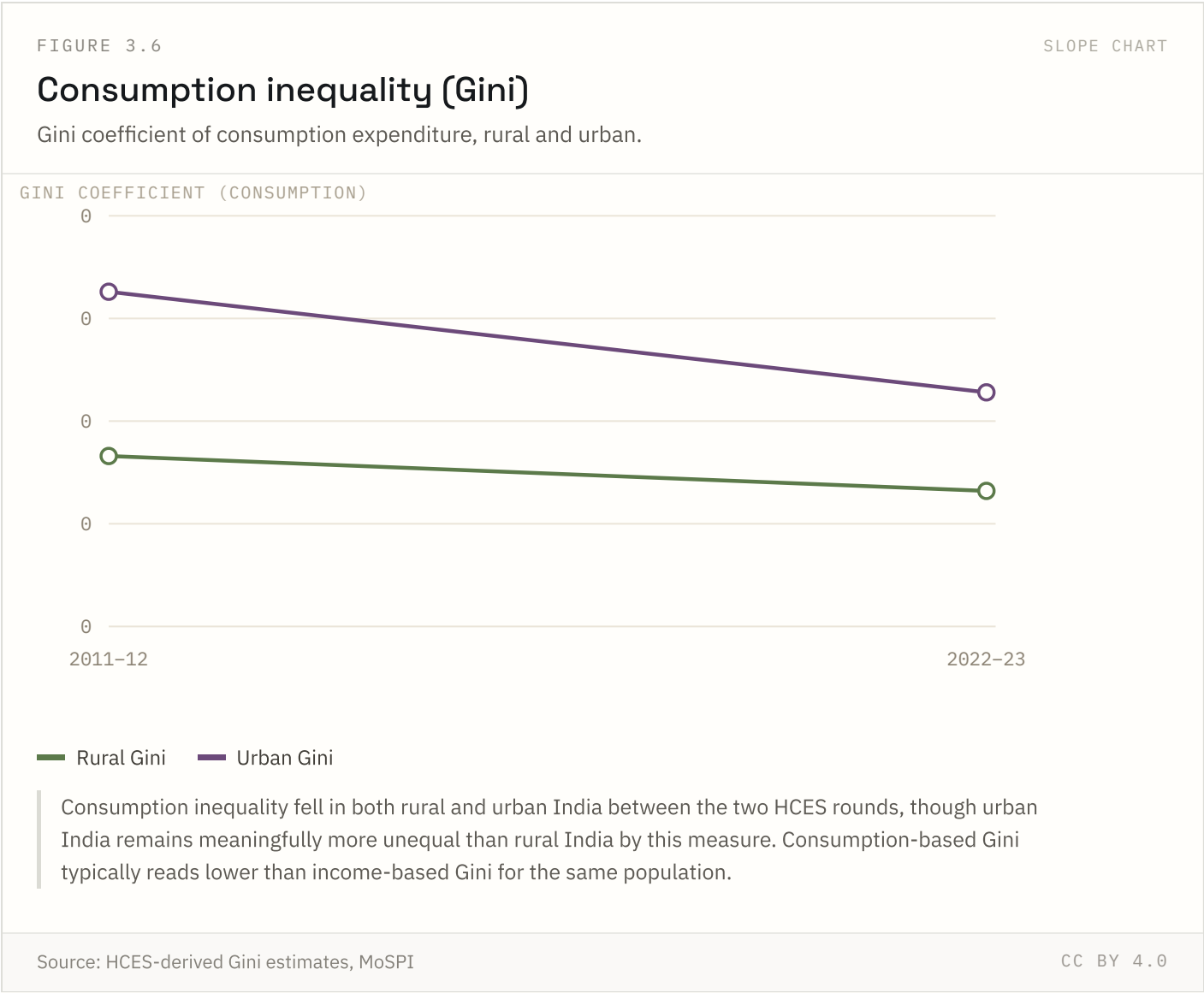
Updated: 18 Aug 2026



MPCE is the bridge between GDP growth and how households actually live — it is the base data used to estimate poverty and inequality. The urban-rural gap (roughly 70%) has narrowed only slightly across the two rounds.

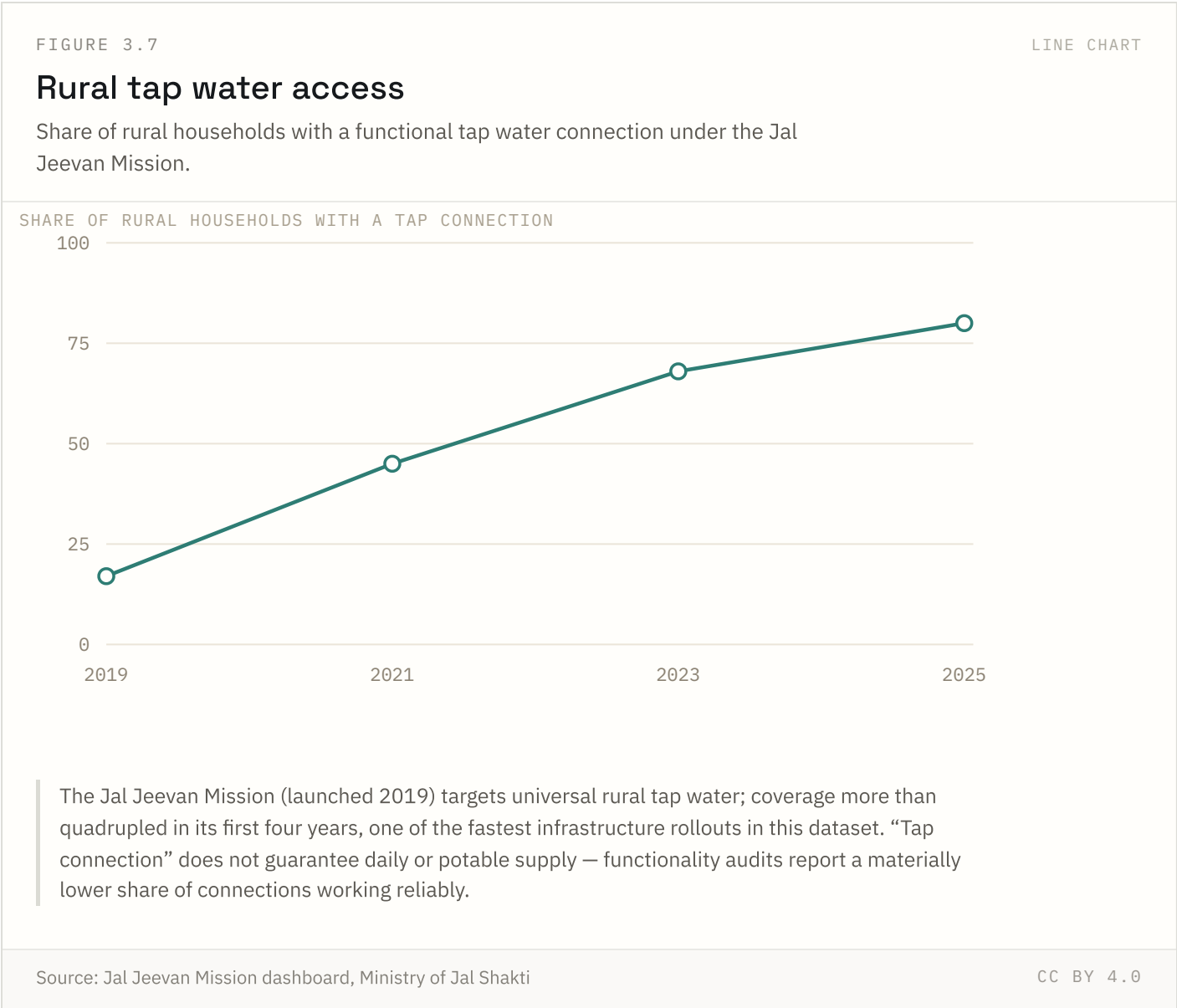
Source: Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI Coverage: 2022–23 to 2023–24

Updated: 18 Aug 2026



Both rural and urban inequality fell between the two survey rounds. Consumption-based Gini is structurally lower than income-based Gini for the same population, since consumption smooths over income volatility — comparisons with countries that report income Gini should account for this.

FIGURE 3.7 NATIONAL ONLY

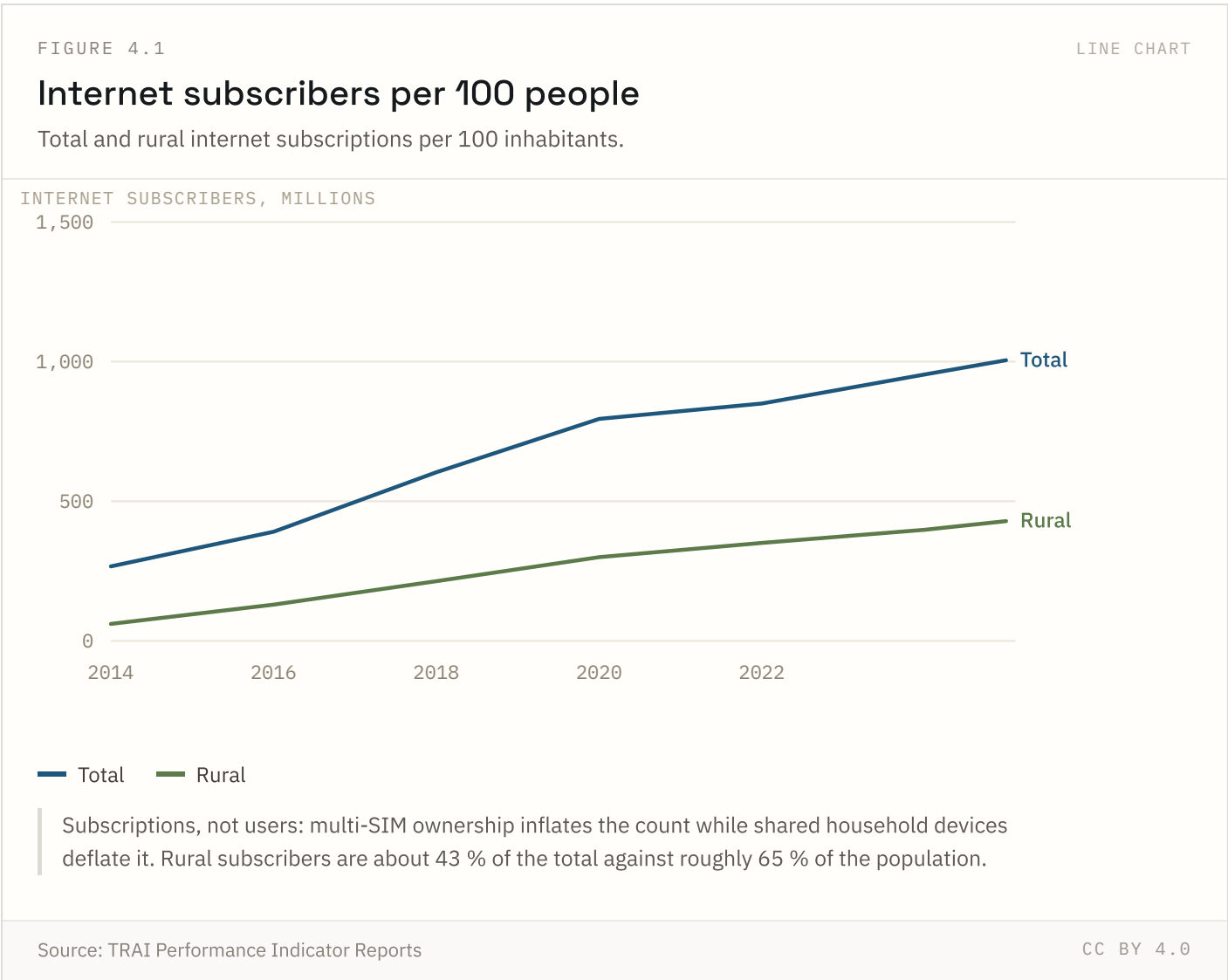


Coverage rose from under a fifth of rural households in 2019 to roughly four-fifths by 2025, one of the fastest rural infrastructure rollouts in this dataset. A reported connection does not guarantee daily supply or potability — independent functionality audits typically report a lower working share.

Digital & internet access

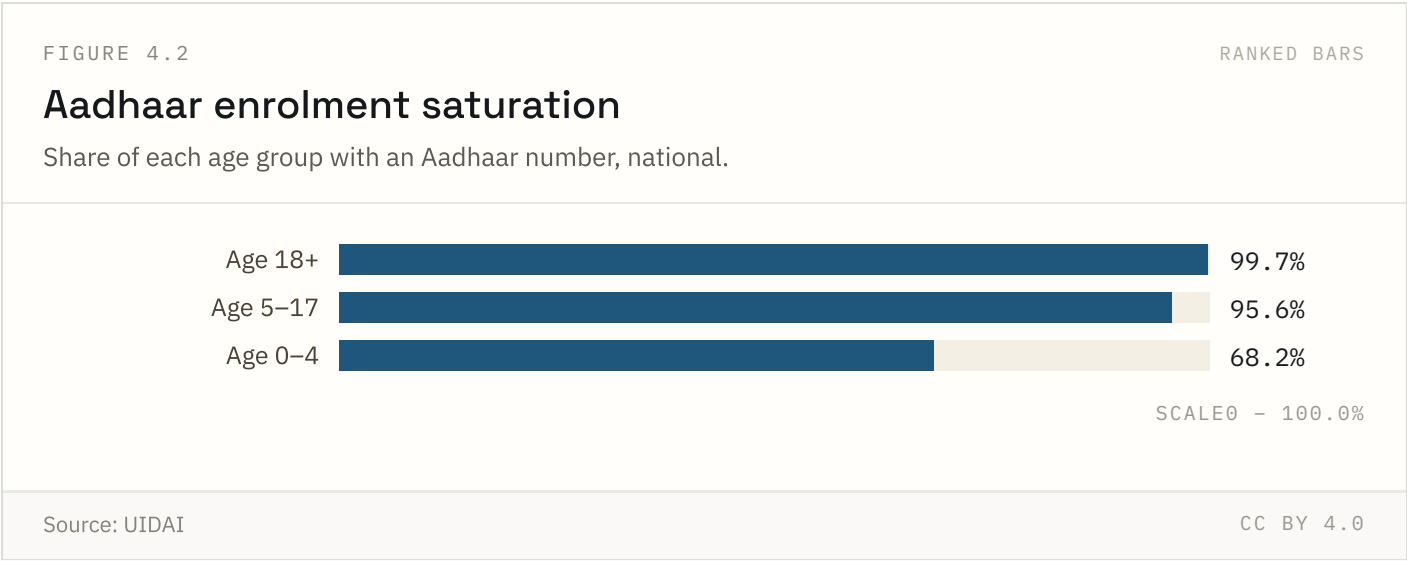
1 of 3 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 4.1 NATIONAL + STATE



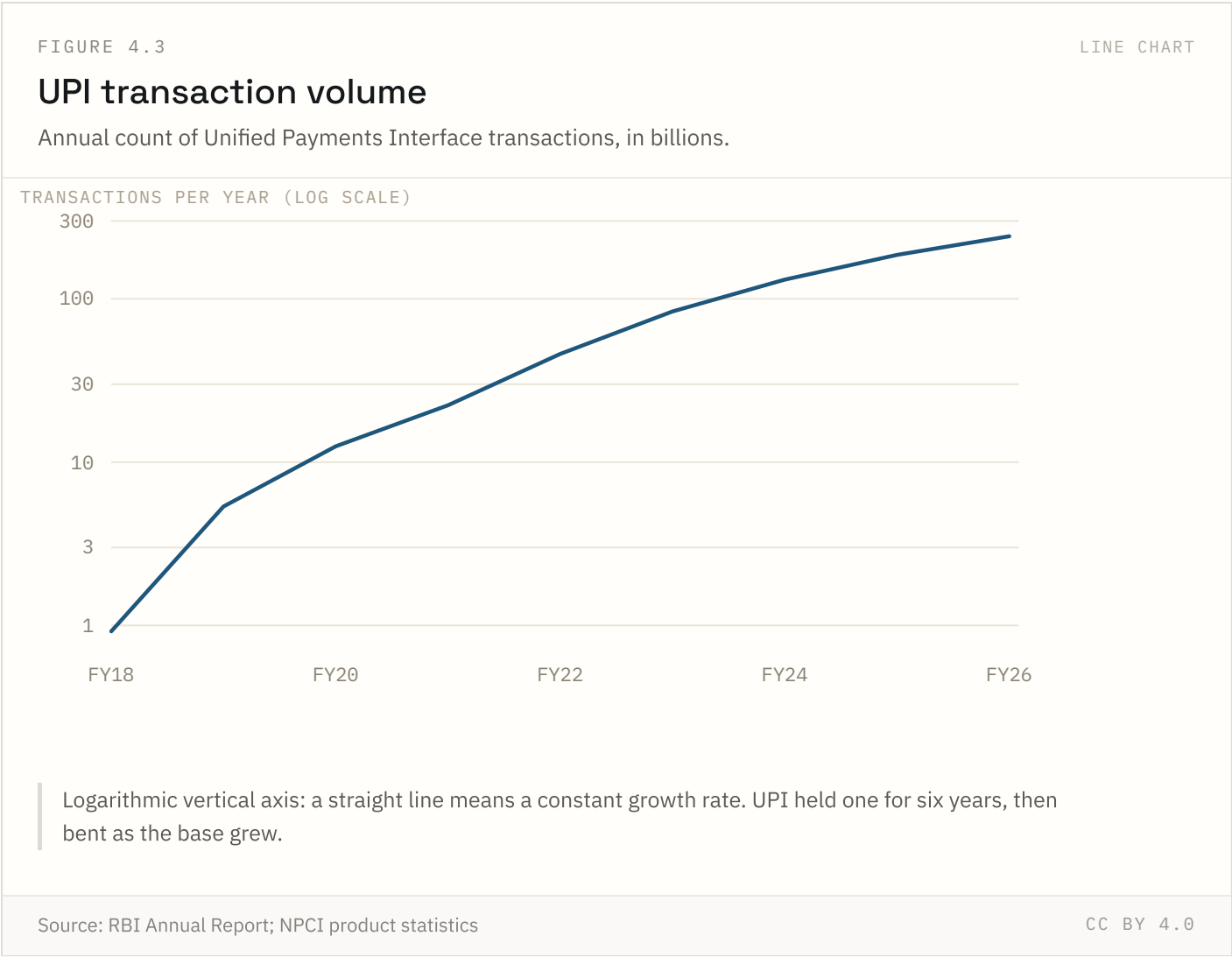
Subscriptions are not users: multi-SIM ownership inflates the numerator, while shared household devices deflate it. The rural–urban gap has narrowed since 2016 but remains roughly 30 points.

FIGURE 4.2 NATIONAL ONLY



Saturation is near-complete for adults, the population that matters most for financial and welfare access. The lower figure for children under 5 mostly reflects a lag between birth and enrolment, not a policy gap — Aadhaar is issued from birth on parental consent.

FIGURE 4.3 NATIONAL ONLY



UPI passed 200 billion transactions a year within eight years of launch, making it the largest real-time retail payment system in the world by count. Average ticket size has fallen steadily as usage moved to small merchant payments.

Source: RBI Annual Report; NPCI product statistics Coverage: 2018–2025 Updated: 05 Aug 2026

Methodology and limitations

Every figure in this report is reproduced from a published source without adjustment. India Insight Lab does not estimate, model or interpolate the values shown. Each chart carries the source it came from, the years it covers and the date the series was last updated.

Three limitations apply to everything above, and are stated rather than worked around:

- Geographic depth.** Indicators reach national and, for 7 of 26 series, state level. District and city figures are not included because comparable data is not yet integrated.

- **Comparability across sources.** Series drawn from different sources use different definitions, reference periods and sampling designs. They are shown side by side but are not adjusted onto a common basis.
- **Currency.** Update dates vary by series; the most recent revision date is shown beneath each figure. Some official series lag by several years.

Nothing in this report is projected. Where a series ends, the report ends with it. No forecast, scenario or extrapolation has been added to extend a trend beyond its published data.

References

25 sources used in this report.

1	DGCI&S, Ministry of Commerce & Industry
2	DPIIT, FDI Statistics
3	HCES-derived Gini estimates, MoSPI
4	Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI
5	Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti
6	Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services
7	MGNREGA MIS, Ministry of Rural Development
8	MoSPI, Consumer Price Index
9	MoSPI, National Accounts Statistics (2011–12 series)
10	NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025)
11	NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023
12	National Accounts Statistics, MoSPI
13	PLFS Annual Report 2023–24, MoSPI
14	PLFS Annual Reports 2017–18 to 2023–24, MoSPI
15	Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell (PPAC)
16	RBI Annual Report; NPCI product statistics

17	RBI Financial Stability Report
18	RBI Monetary Policy Committee resolutions
19	RBI Weekly Statistical Supplement
20	RBI; World Bank India Development Update, April 2026
21	TRAII Performance Indicator Reports
22	Trade Intelligence and Analytics portal, Department of Commerce
23	UIDAI
24	World Bank India Development Update, April 2026
25	World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief, India (2025)

Source URLs, licence terms and retrieval dates are not yet recorded for every series. Adding them is scheduled work, and until it is done these references name the publication rather than link to it.